

UNDERSTANDING TEXTILE IMPORTS TO SAUDI ARABIA

The Essential Guide to
Conformity Assessment for
textile imports in Saudi Arabia

www.exporting-to-saudi.com

Call us: +971 50 459 9607
+971 4 268 2716

Email us: staff.saudi@cotecna.com

– DISCLAIMER –

Data provided herein is for information purposes only and represents the opinion and analysis of the author at the time of publication. The author neither confirms nor guarantees the exhaustiveness and/or accuracy of the contents of this document.

CONTENT

1. INTRODUCTION	1
2. TEXTILE TRADE STATISTICS	2
Global Textile Trade Overview	2
Saudi Arabian Textile Import Market	2
Exporting Countries of Textile to Saudi Arabia	4
Exported Textile Products to Saudi Arabia	5
3. PRODUCT STANDARDS FOR TEXTILE IMPORTS INTO SAUDI ARABIA	6
Textile Products Safety Regulations (TPSR)	7
Labeling Regulations (TPLR)	8
Chemical Requirements of Textile Products	9
4. DOCUMENTATION REQUIREMENTS	10
5. TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS	11
6. IMPORTING & EXPORTING PROCESS	14
Importing Textile Products to Saudi Arabia Process	14
Exporting Textile Products from India to Saudi Arabia Process	14
Obtaining COC at Cotecna	15
7. CASE STUDY: ENSURING THE LEGITIMACY OF TEXTILE GOODS	16
8. APPENDIX	24
Conclusion	24
More about SASO	25
More about Cotecna	26
More about Wimpey Laboratories	27
References	28



1 INTRODUCTION

Saudi Arabia is the largest economy in the Middle East and North Africa (MENA) region and a major player in the global textile and apparel market. The country has a large population of more than 34 million, with a growing population that is increasingly interested in fashion and clothing. As a result, Saudi Arabia imports a significant amount of textiles and clothing from around the world. It is crucial for importers to comply with the stringent regulations and requirements before importing textile products into Saudi Arabia to ensure the safety and quality of these products, and to meet the market demands of this thriving industry.

This white paper aims to provide an overview of the regulations that govern textile imports to Saudi Arabia. It will cover the procedures, requirements, and documentation needed to import textiles into the country.

Moreover, the whitepaper provides a study with an actual case of how to ensure the legitimacy of textile goods, in collaboration with Wimpey laboratories.

[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)



2 TEXTILE TRADE STATISTICS

GLOBAL TEXTILE TRADE OVERVIEW

The global textile trade is a vast and dynamic industry that involves the production, distribution, and sale of a wide range of textile products. According to the World Trade Organization, the global trade of textiles and apparel was valued at over \$700 billion in 2020, with several countries playing a significant role in this trade, making it one of the largest sectors in international trade. The top importing countries in 2021 were USA, Germany & Japan. In 2021, Saudi Arabia imported \$8.05B in Textiles, becoming the 27th largest importer of textiles in the world. That same year, textile products were the 7th most imported products in Saudi Arabia. This included clothing, fabrics, home textiles, yarn & threads.

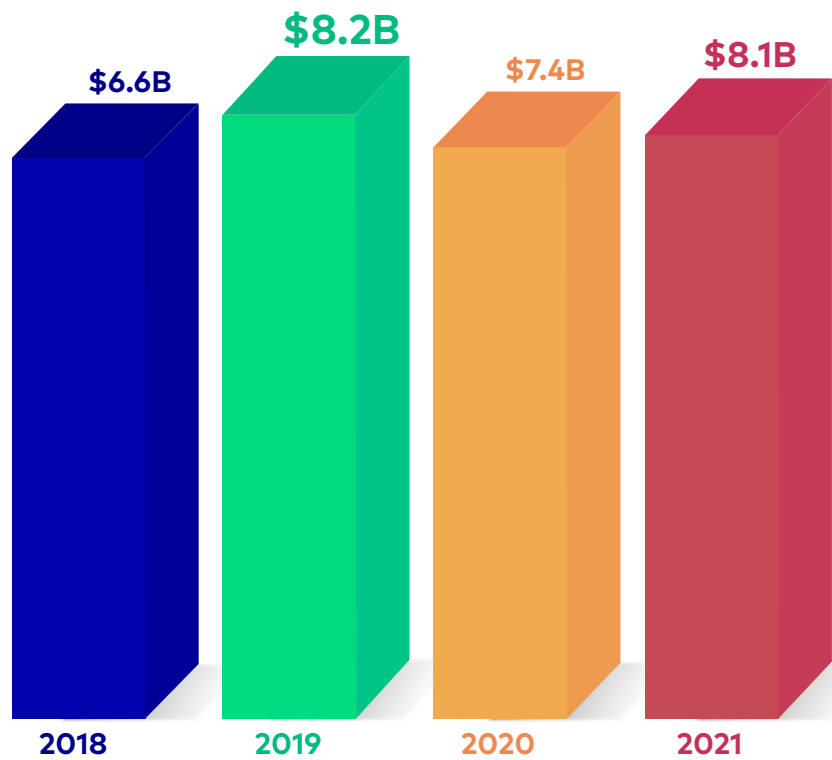
SAUDI ARABIAN TEXTILE IMPORT MARKET

Over the past few years, the textile import market in Saudi Arabia has experienced a significant growth trend. From 2018 to 2021, the market has grown at an average annual rate of 13-15%, reaching a current value of over \$8B. This growth can be attributed to various factors such as an increasing demand for textile products, the expansion of the retail industry, and the growing awareness among consumers regarding quality and safety standards.

[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)

Below a graph showing the growth rate of textile import market in Saudi Arabia, according to The Observatory of Economic Complexity:

SAUDI ARABIA TEXTILE MARKET GROWTH



**amount in USD*

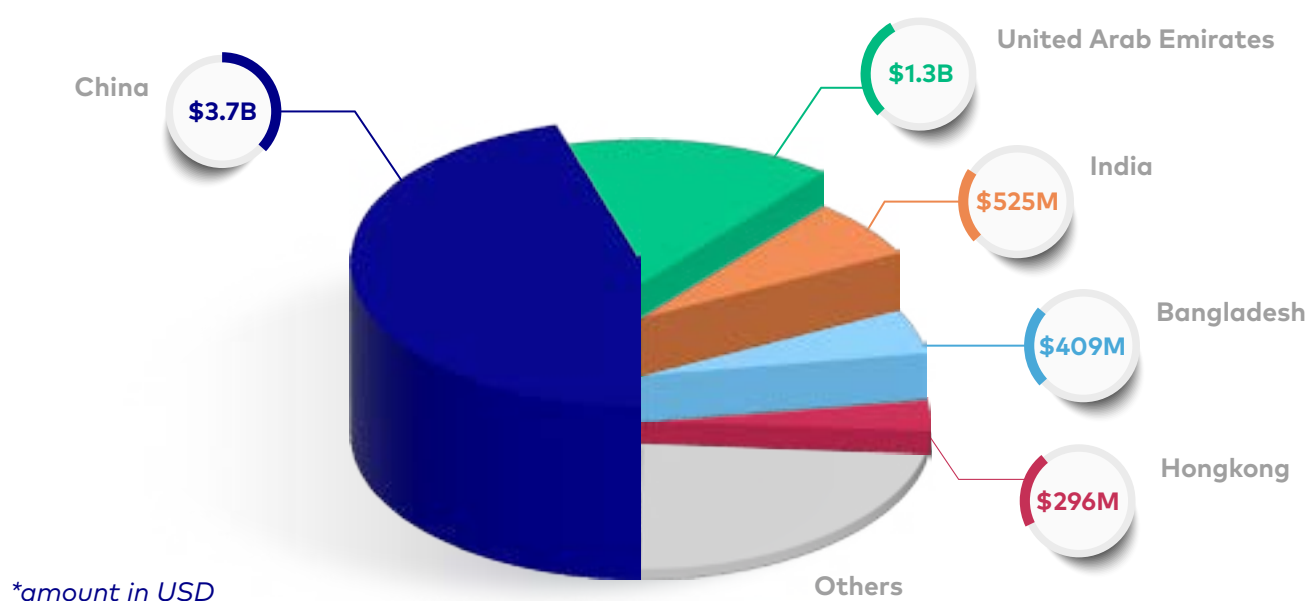


GO BACK TO CONTENTS



EXPORTING COUNTRIES OF TEXTILE TO SAUDI ARABIA

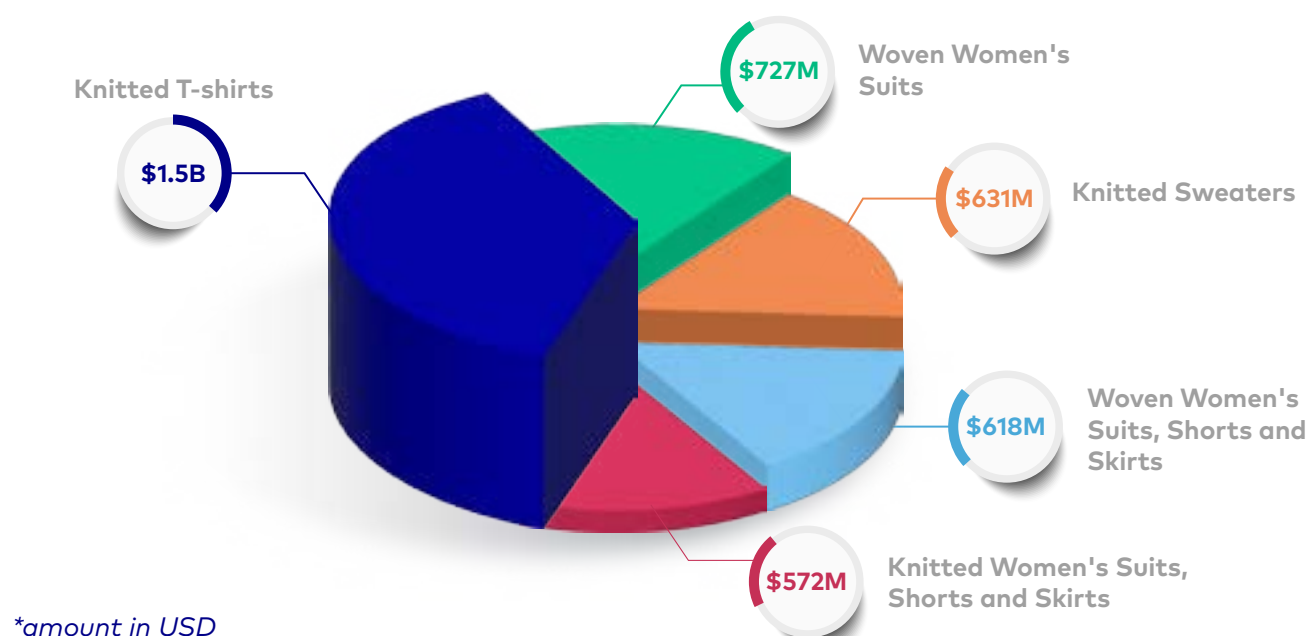
In 2021, and according to The Observatory of Economic Complexity, Saudi Arabia imports textiles primarily from some major exporting countries that include **China, UAE, India, Bangladesh, and Hong Kong**. These countries have a strong textile industry and are known for their quality and affordability. China is the largest exporter of textiles to Saudi Arabia, followed by United Arab Emirates and India. These countries have a significant share in the Saudi Arabian textile import market and are expected to continue to dominate in the coming years. However, there are also other countries that are emerging as potential textile exporters to Saudi Arabia, such as Vietnam and Ethiopia, which are gradually increasing their market share in the industry.



[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)

EXPORTED TEXTILE PRODUCTS TO SAUDI ARABIA

According to data from the UN Comtrade database, the top textile products exported to Saudi Arabia in 2020 were:



It is worth noting that these figures only include textile products that are classified under **HS codes 61 and 62**, which cover apparel and clothing accessories. Other textile products, such as fabrics and yarns, may be imported into Saudi Arabia under different HS codes.



[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)



3 PRODUCT STANDARDS FOR TEXTILE IMPORTS INTO SAUDI ARABIA

The Saudi Standards, Metrology and Quality Organization (SASO) is responsible for developing, issuing, and enforcing standards and regulations related to textile products imported into Saudi Arabia. All textile products imported into the country must comply with SASO's technical regulations and standards to ensure that they meet certain quality standards and pose no risk to public health or safety.

At Cotecna, we accompany that importers obtain the necessary documentation and certificates to ensure that their products comply with these standards and avoid any negative implications of non-compliance. This include products safety, labeling regulations, and chemical requirements.

[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)

TEXTILE PRODUCTS SAFETY REGULATIONS (TPSR)

The TPSR sets out the safety requirements for textile products to ensure that they do not pose a risk to public health or safety. The regulation covers chemical and physical properties, labeling requirements, and testing procedures.

1. Chemical Properties

The TPSR sets limits on the levels of certain chemicals that may be present in textile products, such as formaldehyde, heavy metals, and azo dyes. These chemicals can be harmful to human health if they exceed the allowable limits.

2. Physical Properties

The TPSR also specifies the physical properties that textile products must meet, such as strength, durability, and colorfastness. These properties ensure that the products will perform as expected and not deteriorate quickly with use.

3. Labeling Requirements

The TPSR requires that textile products be labeled with certain information, including the name of the product, the fiber content, the country of origin, and care instructions. The labeling must be clear and easy to read.

4. Testing Methods

The TPSR requires that textile products undergo testing to ensure that they meet the required safety standards. Tests may include colorfastness, shrinkage, and flammability testing. The test methods shall be within the accreditation scope of the lab and be of a method approved by SASO.



[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)



TEXTILE PRODUCTS LABELING REGULATIONS (TPLR)

The TPLR sets out the labeling requirements for textile products. The regulation requires that textile products be labeled with the following information:

1. Types of fibers of which a product consist of; prescribed with its names, followed by the mass percentages, as per the relevant standards. The humidity levels in the annex of the technical regulation shall be considered in calculation of the fabric mass.
2. Information of weight, size & dimensions.
3. Supplier's name and his commercial register on the external packaging.
4. Country of origin.
5. Information & symbols of textile products related to appropriate washing & cleaning guidelines and instructions that ensure safety of a product & ensure validity of information and conformity of symbols.
6. Labels shall not contain any verses of Qur'an or the word "Allah", nor images & sentences used in product packaging that contrary to the public order, morals & Islamic values prevailing in the KSA.
7. Labels shall be tightly fixed on the product, in such a way to be difficult to remove as per the requirements of this Regulation & as stipulated in the field of textile & sewing.
8. Information shall be written on the labels in clear letters & shall be uniformed in terms of size & font; to be read easily by the consumer upon procurement, including e-purchases. In addition, it shall be written in Arabic or Arabic and English in an indelible manner.

Depending on the type of textile product, there may be additional labeling requirements. For example, children's clothing and bedding products may be required to include safety warnings and other information.

[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)



CHEMICAL REQUIREMENTS OF TEXTILE PRODUCTS

When Importing textile products to Saudi Arabia, there are specific requirements that must be met in order to ensure the safety and quality of the products.

These requirements include identifying the limits of presence of:

- > Formaldehyde
- > Pentachlorophenol (PCP), Tetrachlorophenol (TeCP) and Ortho-Phenylphenol (OPP)
- > Heavy Metals <Antimony (Sb) Arsenic (As) Lead (Pb) Cadmium (Cd) Mercury (Hg) Copper (Cu) Total Chromium (Cr) VI Cobalt (Co) Nickel (Ni)>
- > Carcinogenic Amines in Azo Dyes
- > Azo Dyes
- > Flame Retardants
- > Insecticides, Herbicides and Fungicides
- > Organic Chlorinated Compounds (chlorinated benzenes, toluenes and naphtalenes)
- > Phthalates
- > Organotin Compounds
- > Identifying pH Value
- > Color Stability Test for washing, perspiration and friction + for children's clothing, color stability of saliva

This is in addition to the relevant product specific standards listed in the annex of the regulation or the Wasif standards store.

Note: Product that have obtained an ecological badge, or the equivalent thereof issued by one of the approved bodies by SASO shall be deemed in conformity with all requirements stated herein", SASO is sending a circular to confirm that CBs can accept the Ecological badge/ label or its equivalent from international organization without the need to do the conformity assessment procedures or the factory audit for that product after verifying the certificate validity and its compliance to SASO standards.

[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)



4 DOCUMENTATION REQUIREMENTS

Importers must obtain the necessary documentation and certificates to import textiles into Saudi Arabia. These include a Certificate of Conformity, Commercial Invoice, Bill of Lading, and Packing List. The Certificate of Conformity verifies that the imported textile product complies with the relevant SASO standards and regulations, while the other documents contain information about the imported goods, including the price, quantity, description, packaging, and contents of the shipment.

This include:

- > **Commercial Registration and Investment License**
Obtained from the Ministry of Commerce and Ministry of Investment.
- > **Certificate of Conformity (CoC)**
This certificate is issued by an notified third-party certification body and verifies that the imported textile product complies with the relevant SASO standards and regulations.
- > **Commercial Invoice**
This document contains information about the imported goods, including the price, quantity, and description of the product.
- > **Bill of Lading**
This document is issued by the shipping company and contains information about the goods being transported, including the name and address of the exporter and importer, the shipping date, and the port of discharge.
- > **Packing List**
This document contains information about the packaging and contents of the shipment, including the number of packages, weight, and dimensions.

[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)



5 TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS

SASO has developed the Technical Regulation of textile products imports concerning general safety, here we can provide you with a comprehensive list of it:

> **Technical Regulation**

A document approved by The Board that provides, the specifications of products, associated processes and production methods, including applicable administrative provisions; with which compliance is mandatory. It may include or pay attention to terms, definitions, packaging, and requirements of markings or labelling products, services, processes or production methods.

> **Standard**

A document determines specifications of products, its measures, its quality level and its safety requirements levels. It includes terms, definitions, packaging, and requirements of markings or labelling products, services, processes or production methods.

> **Essential Requirements**

The special requirements of the products; that may affect the safety, health, and the environment; that must be adhered to.

> **Market Surveillance**

Activities and measures carried out by the market surveillance authorities to verify that products meet the requirements stipulated in the relevant technical regulations, and to ensure that they do not pose a risk to health, safety, environment, or any other aspect related to the protection of the public interest.

[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)

> **Market Surveillance Authorities**

Government body/bodies responsible for carrying out market surveillance.

> **Regulatory Authorities**

Governmental body/bodies with regulatory tasks in consonance according to their specializations, which are responsible for the implementation and enforcement of technical regulations, whether in customs, markets, or manufactories.

> **Hazard(s)**

A potential source of harm.

> **Risk(s)**

A potential risk causing damage; associated with the severity of damage.

> **Supplier**

Any official or non-official person in the supply chain, whose activities may have an impact on the characteristics of the product.

> **Conformity Assessment Procedures**

A document approved by the Board of Directors, which describes the procedures used directly, or indirectly for the conformity assessment.

> **Notified Bodies**

Conformity Assessment Bodies "Third Party", approved by SASO in accordance with the regulation of approving Conformity Assessment Bodies.

> **Certificate of Conformity**

A certificate issued by SASO or a notified body, which ensures the conformity of a product, or any batch thereof, with the requirements of relevant standards.

> **Supplier Declaration of Conformity**

A declaration by the supplier by which it declares that a product conforms to the requirements herein and applicable legislations, without the mandatory intervention of a third party neither in the design stage, nor in the production stage of the manufacturing process. A declaration may depend on testing the product in accordance with the relevant legislation.

> **Saudi Quality Mark**

A mark granted by SASO, which declares that the establishment has an effective management system, which ensures that the products they supply are produced in accordance with the applicable regulations, granting procedures, and the relevant Saudi standards.

> **Placing on Market**

Launching a product for the first time in the Saudi market for which the manufacturer/supplier is responsible.

> **Display in the Market**

Any supply of the product for distribution, consumption or use in the KSA, in the course of a commercial activity, in return for payment or free of charge.

[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)

> **Withdrawal**

Any procedure that aims to prevent placing a product in the market and in a supply chain.

> **Recall**

Any procedure that aims to recall products made available for the enduser, according to the recall regulation.

All textile products under the scope of the technical regulation are required to comply with the applicable SASO, GSO, international or regional standards listed in the annex of the technical regulation. The technical regulation also sets out the required certification scheme for issuing a Certificate of Conformity depending on the type of products:

- > Type 3 for children's products and underwear
- > Type 1a for all other textile products

Note: This preamble and all the annexes of this regulation shall form an integral part thereof.



[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)



6 IMPORTING & EXPORTING PROCESS

IMPORTING TEXTILE PRODUCTS TO SAUDI ARABIA PROCESS

1. Obtain a Commercial Registration and investment license from Ministry of Commerce and Ministry of Investment.
2. Ensure compliance with technical regulations and obtain necessary certifications.
3. Arrange shipment of the product to Saudi Arabia.
4. Pay import duties and taxes.
5. Submit documentation to Saudi customs and obtain clearance.
6. Distribute and sell the products in the Saudi Arabian market.

EXPORTING TEXTILE PRODUCTS FROM SAUDI ARABIA PROCESS

1. Obtain an export license from the Director General of Foreign Trade or its regional offices.
2. Ensure compliance with technical regulations and obtain necessary certifications.
3. Comply with marking requirements set out in SASO ISO 3758: 2012.
4. Ensure all necessary customs documentation is in order.
5. Pay export duties and taxes, if applicable.
6. Arrange shipping and logistics of the product to Saudi Arabia.

These processes may vary depending on the specific product being imported or exported, the location of the importer or exporter, and other factors. It is important to work with qualified professionals to ensure compliance with all relevant regulations and to facilitate a smooth process.

[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)

OBTAINING COC AT COTECNA

At Cotecna, we specialize in providing certification services to ensure that your products meet all relevant technical regulations and standards for the Saudi Arabian market. Our team of experts will work with you to thoroughly evaluate and test your products to ensure compliance with all the necessary requirements. By obtaining a COC, you will not only ensure that your products meet the necessary technical standards, but you will also gain a competitive advantage in the Saudi Arabian market. Our certification will demonstrate to your customers that your products are of the highest quality and that you take their safety and well-being seriously.

The SASO/SABER aims to protect the businesses from fraud and ensure that products are free from defects that may affect the health and safety of consumers. It includes a two-stage certification process to export products into the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia:

- 1.) Product Certificate of Conformity (PCOC)
- 2.) Shipment Certificate of Conformity (SCOC)

Step-by-Step Process

1. The importer enters his company details on SABER Platform
2. Selection of Cotecna as your notified Certification Body
3. Cotecna accesses the SABER platform and checks the requests
4. Cotecna guides you on how to register your products on SABER Platform to obtain your PCOC
5. Cotecna helps you to upload of your product documentation on SABER Platform
6. Your dedicated Cotecna coordinator will check your documentation and schedule the testing, or audit when required
7. After satisfactory results, Cotecna will issue the product certificate (valid one year)
8. Cotecna will issue the shipment certificate for each of your shipments.

We would be happy to answer any questions you may have and provide you with a detailed quote for our certification services. Please let us know how we can assist you in ensuring the compliance of your products and the success of your business in the Saudi Arabian market.

To get a free quote or to get a certificate for your exports, please [contact us](#).

For more information about SASO programme you can [visit our dedicated programme page](#).



CASE STUDY: ENSURING THE LEGITIMACY OF TEXTILE GOODS CASE STUDY



In collaboration with **Wimpey Laboratories**, we are providing below a study with an actual case of how to ensure the legitimacy of textile goods.

Wimpey is an analytical testing and calibration laboratory that provides advanced qualitative standardization facilities of Testing, Inspection, and Consultancy services across the globe. Operating their services from the Middle East, specifically from **Dubai**, and **Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates (UAE)**.

1.0 INTRODUCTION:

The Growing Concern of Clothing Quality and Authenticity: With the increasing global demand for clothing, there is a growing focus on the production practices of fashion brands. Many are concerned about the production of garments that may not meet the expected standards of quality. Such garments often have shorter lifespans, which can contribute to higher levels of post-consumer waste. Our objective is to delve into the underlying issues related to textile products, across various fabric types, and propose strategies to enhance their durability. One of the key challenges in this endeavor is ensuring the authenticity of textile products. Characteristics in textiles that may not meet the desired standards can often be attributed to a variety of factors including raw materials, the spinning process, weaving, knitting, and dyeing.

Wimpey Laboratories, a division of Cotecna Inspection SA has conducted extensive studies in two primary areas:

Physical Defects: These are visible to the naked eye and include issues such as seam puckering, open or broken seams, discoloration, and holes in seams, among others.

Chemical-Related Defects: These encompass the use of flame retardants, restricted dyes, and other chemicals in the garment manufacturing process.

Addressing these challenges is essential not only for improving the quality and longevity of textiles but also for ensuring the authenticity of products in the fashion industry.

[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)

2.0 BACKGROUND:

US retailer Target severed ties with textile manufacturer Welspun India in 2016 after realizing that over 750,000 bedlinens such as sheets and pillowcases were fake and mislabeled as Egyptian cotton and they were not the pure long- and extra-long-staple Egyptian cotton after all.

Further on, the Cotton Egypt Association estimated that 90 percent of global supplies of Egyptian cotton in 2016 were fake. Not just Egyptian cotton, recently in 2020, the Global Organic Textile Standard (GOTS) opined around 20,000 tons of Indian cotton had been incorrectly certified as premium organic cotton which translated to a sixth of the country's total production. A famous silk brand from Vietnam also owned up that over half of its silk was inferior silk from China. Animal rights activists supported several British retailers in 2018 who withdraw their faux fur winter garments which were found to be from actual dead and skinned animals. Even synthetic fabrics such as polyester fabrics are mislabeled as over 60 percent of those claiming to be from recycled plastic bottles with lower carbon footprint were made from virgin plastic.

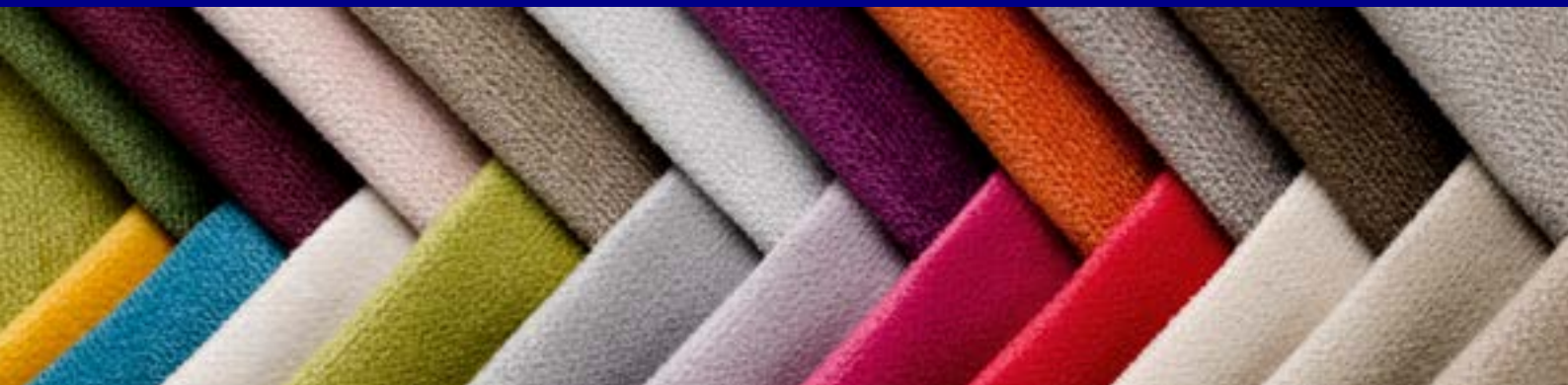
3.0 SIGNIFICANCE OF THIS CASE STUDY:

Ensuring the Authenticity of Textile Products: Upholding Quality and Trust. The process of verifying the authenticity of textile products plays a crucial role in assuring consumers of genuine, safe, and high-quality goods. Like many other industries, the textile sector faces the significant challenge of counterfeit or substandard products flooding the market. These imitation textiles not only undermine consumer confidence but also pose potential risks to health and safety due to inferior materials and low-quality dyes. Therefore, ensuring the authenticity of textile products is a vital cornerstone in safeguarding consumer well-being and upholding compliance with regulations.

Consumers are naturally attracted to suppliers who commit to delivering top-notch products. However, the market is saturated with products that do not meet the standards set by regulatory authorities. In the context of this case study, a comprehensive examination was conducted on a selection of 20 diverse products sourced from the market. The following list provides insights into a few of the samples scrutinized during the course of this case study:



[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)



4.0 ROLE OF COTECNA GROUP:

Cotecna Group plays a pivotal role in the authentication process by offering inspection and testing services tailored to textile products. As a trusted and internationally recognized entity, Cotecna brings a wealth of expertise and experience to the table. They utilize a combination of cutting-edge technology, industry knowledge, and standardized testing methods to determine the authenticity of textile products.

5.0 SASO 277.T STANDARD:

The reference to SASO 277.T (Color Fastness to Water, Rubbing, Perspiration, etc.) indicates that Cotecna Group employs specific testing procedures outlined in this standard. SASO (Saudi Standards, Metrology, and Quality Organization) is responsible for developing and maintaining standards in Saudi Arabia, ensuring product quality and safety. SASO 277.T focuses on assessing the color fastness of textiles under various conditions, including exposure to water, rubbing, and perspiration.

6.0 PROCESS OF AUTHENTICITY TESTING:

Authenticity testing typically involves the following steps:

a. Sample Collection: Representatives from Cotecna Group collect samples of the textile products in question. These samples are often selected randomly to ensure unbiased results.

b. Testing Protocols: The collected samples are subjected to standardized testing protocols, such as SASO 277.T, to assess their authenticity. This might involve exposing the samples to water, rubbing, or perspiration under controlled conditions and measuring their color fastness.

c. Analysis: The results of these tests are analyzed meticulously. Any deviations from established standards or signs of substandard quality are documented.

d. Authentication Report: A detailed report is generated, outlining the findings of the authenticity tests. This report serves as a critical tool for manufacturers, regulators, and consumers to make informed decisions about the tested textile products.

[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)

DEFECTS IN THE GARMENTS CAN BE CATEGORIZED INTO FOLLOWING CATEGORIES:

1. Physical Defects

Physicals defects can further be classified into:

- a) **The quality defects:** A quality defect is a problem with a product or service that does not meet the specified quality standards. This will be a simple guideline to find out a non-compliant product
- b) **Fabric defects:** A fabric defect corresponds to a flaw on the fabric surface.
- c) **Garment defects:** Manufacturing defects such as faulty zippers, irregular hemming, loose buttons, raw edges, improper buttonholes, uneven parts, inappropriate trimming, and difference in fabric colors. A good indication of the authenticity of the product.

2. Chemical Defects

CHEMICALS IN OUR CLOTHING									
Chemicals:		Flame Retardants	PFAS	Lead	Chromium	Phthalates	Chlorine Bleach	Azo dyes	VOCs
IMPACT CATEGORIES	Probable Carcinogens	✓	✓✓	✓	✓	✓	✓✓	✓	✓
	Skin irritants	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓✓	✓	✓
	Hormone Disrupters	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Environmental degradation (Water pollution)	✓✓	✓✓	✓	✓	✓✓	✓	✓	✓

- ✓ Short-term or acute exposure can lead to health impacts
- ✓✓ Prolonged or extensive exposure can lead to health impacts

Chemical defects can be further classified into:

- a) **Azo dyes:** These dyes make up 60-70% of the fabric colorants and are responsible for the vivid colors that can be seen in many textiles, especially clothing concentrated in black and brown pigmentation. Very limited exposure of these dyes was found in this specific case study. But none of the samples are above the specification limits.
- b) **Flame Retardants:** Were designed to stop clothing from burning and are required for children's clothing. During the study, we haven't observed any such issues.
- c) **Phthalates:** Phthalates are used in activewear and anti-odor clothing, printing inks and processing. These are plasticizers, used with rubber to print images onto the garments and are predominantly known to be carcinogenic and endocrine disruption. We found 3 products with phthalates and noncompliant.

[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)

d) **Heavy metals:** Heavy metals like lead and chromium are used to stabilize the colors in the dyeing process. When high concentrations of these chemicals meet on the skin or its ingested, they cause cancer and dermatitis. When clothes containing these compounds are washed, they cause environmental damage. It was observed 2 products having higher values than standard.

SPECIFIC OBSERVATIONS FOUND IN THE CASE STUDY:

1. Seam Puckering

Seam puckering refers to the gathering of a seam either just after sewing or after laundering causing an unacceptable seam appearance (**Fig. 1**).



Figure 1

2. Open Seam or Broken Seam

Portion of the garment that has not been covered by sewing thread (**Fig. 2**).



Figure 2

3. Broken Stitch

Non-continuous sewing thread (**Fig. 3**).



Figure 3

4. Drop Stitch/Skipped Stitch

Irregular stitching along the seam (**Fig. 4**).



Figure 4

5. Uncut/Loose thread

Extra threads or loose threads on seam line (**Fig. 5**).



Figure 5

6. Distorted Knitting

Description missing (**Fig. 6**).



Figure 6

[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)

7.0 INDUSTRY STRATEGY AND GARMENT DURABILITY:

Introduced in 2012, WRAP's Sustainable Clothing Action Plan initiated substantial engagement among retailers and brands regarding the longevity of garments. This engagement primarily revolved around product categories such as school wear, outdoor apparel, and technical products.

The research conducted as part of this initiative unveiled a significant absence of a unified approach to assess or assure the physical durability of garments. In contrast to other product categories where key quality levels and anticipatory design engineering are employed to mitigate risks, the textile industry lacked such standardized measures. Additionally, there is a notable absence of legislative standards directly applicable to garments, except for the general requirement under consumer legislation that necessitates goods to be 'fit for purpose'.

The research also brought to light the presence of **established testing procedures for textiles**, components, and the final garment product. However, the adoption of these procedures is inconsistent across various brands and retailers. Furthermore, the pass/fail criteria for these tests are set individually, often tailored to the specific market position of the brand or retailer, and occasionally varying across different product categories.

The survey:

The garment condition survey provided insights into the various types of physical failures observed in garments discarded by their owners. The most prevalent issues were related to color fading, particularly evident in jersey and woven fabrics, and pilling of knitwear and jersey items. Additional common problems encompassed fabric breakdown, such as fraying or thinning, primarily occurring around hems, as well as wear and tear around the crotch area of trousers and jeans, and accidental damage such as stains, tears, and rips.

Furthermore, there were instances of other types of failure, including the loss of dimensional stability, logo deterioration, discoloration, especially notable around the collars of white shirts, holes in seams, including those found in jacket linings, and issues with trim components. These observations are summarized in Table 1, and the percentages reflect the prevalence across all garments in the sample. Notably, a substantial proportion of garments, 69%, exhibited either color-related or logo-related problems, while 75% had fabric-related issues. This implies that many garments experienced multiple problems simultaneously.

[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)

Table 1:

Garment problems recorded (% of all garments)

TYPE OF FAILURE	%
Pilling	55
Colour Fading	53
Fabric Breakdown	29
Accidental Damage	29
Loss of Dimensional Stability	20
Logo Failure	16
Discoloration	15
Holes in seam	14
Trim Failure	8

8.0 IMPACT OF AUTHENTICITY TESTING:

Authenticity testing by Cotecna Group not only safeguards consumers from counterfeit or substandard products but also supports manufacturers in upholding their brand reputation and complying with industry and regulatory standards. Additionally, it helps authorities take appropriate action against counterfeiters and unscrupulous practices in the market.

In conclusion, the authenticity testing of textile products, as conducted by Cotecna Group in compliance with standards like SASO 277.T, plays a pivotal role in ensuring consumer safety, maintaining product quality, and upholding industry integrity. It is a crucial step in verifying the legitimacy of textile products, protecting consumers, and fostering trust in the textile industry.

For further information about this case study or the testing of your textile products, please contact [Wimpey laboratories](#).

**GO BACK TO
CONTENTS**



CONCLUSION

The importation of textile products into Saudi Arabia is subject to stringent regulations and standards set by the Saudi Standards, Metrology and Quality Organization (SASO). These regulations encompass chemical and physical properties, labeling requirements, testing procedures, and technical specifications. Compliance with these regulations is essential to ensure the safety, quality, and integrity of textile products in the Saudi Arabian market.

By adhering to these standards, importers, exporters, and manufacturers contribute to the protection of public health and safety, as well as the overall reputation of the textile industry. Cotecna, as a trusted partner of SASO, can assist importers in navigating the complex landscape of textile imports, ensuring that products meet the required standards and regulations before entering the Saudi Arabian Market.

By working closely with importers, Cotecna strives to facilitate a smooth and efficient import process, enabling businesses to seize opportunities in the thriving textile market of Saudi Arabia.

[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)



More about SASO

The Saudi Standards, Metrology and Quality Organization (SASO) is a government body entrusted with all activities related to standards, measurements and quality in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia.

SASO provides the necessary measures for quality control of raw materials and products, and sets necessary conformity procedures of products based on the verification of quality, legislation and application of the Quality Mark Scheme.

The objective of the SASO programme is to ensure that the quality and safety regulations of Saudi Arabia are met and that imported products comply with Saudi standards and the Technical Regulations developed by SASO; thereby protecting the health and safety of consumers, as well as the environment, from the risk of substandard, counterfeit and potentially dangerous goods.

The SASO programme is part of a broader national programme, which aims to set procedures to ensure the safety of local and imported products subject to Saudi Standards and technical regulation.

[GO BACK TO CONTENTS](#)



COTECNA

Trust for a moving world

More about Cotecna

Cotecna is a leading provider of testing, inspection and certification services. We offer solutions to facilitate trade and make supply chains safer and more efficient for our clients. Our technical expertise combined with the superior quality of our services and our ability to anticipate our clients' needs is what sets us apart.

As a trusted partner of Saudi Arabia, Cotecna is notified by SASO to issue a Certificate of Conformity for exports of regulated products to the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia.

Cotecna's mandate consists in issuing Certificates of Conformity (COC) for general goods complying with applicable requirements.

For further information, or to receive a free quote, don't hesitate to [contact us](#).

GO BACK TO
CONTENTS



More about Wimpey Laboratories

Wimpey Laboratories is an independent testing and calibration laboratory with more than two decades of experience in providing services across the globe.

An ISO/IEC 17025:2017 accredited laboratory with the Emirates International Accreditation center (EIAC), Emirates National Accreditation Services (ENAS), and International Accreditation Services (IAS). Wimpey Laboratories operates a quality management system and is a certified ISO 9001:2015, ISO 14001:2015, and ISO 45001:2018 company. We aim to provide services to our customers around the clock.

To discover how these services can benefit you, or to receive a quotation, please [contact us](#).



Cotecna Inspection



WimpeyLaboratories



wimpeylab



cotecna_group



WimpeyLab

GO BACK TO
CONTENTS



REFERENCES

Web links:

Trading Economics - <https://tradingeconomics.com/> (accessed on 1/6/2023)

Fitch Solutions - <https://www.fitchsolutions.com/> (accessed on 1/6/2023)

Zimstat - <https://www.zimstat.co.zw/> (accessed on 1/6/2023)

Global Edge - <https://globaledge.msu.edu/> (accessed on 1/6/2023)

Volza - <https://www.volza.com/> (accessed on 1/6/2023)

Tridge - <https://www.tridge.com/> (accessed on 1/6/2023)

OECD - <https://oec.world/> (accessed on 1/6/2023)

Comtrade - <https://comtrade.un.org/> (accessed on 1/6/2023)

Yumpu - <https://www.yumpu.com/en> (accessed on 1/6/2023)

Drinks Int - <https://drinksint.com/> (accessed on 1/6/2023)

Tilasto - https://www.tilastokeskus.fi/index_en.html (accessed on 1/6/2023)

Mordor Intelligence - <https://www.mordorintelligence.com/> (accessed on 1/6/2023)

WITS Worldbank - <https://wits.worldbank.org/> (accessed on 1/6/2023)

Kohan Textile Journal - <https://kohantextilejournal.com/> (accessed on 1/6/2023)

**GO BACK TO
CONTENTS**



Trust for a moving world



www.cotecna.com
www.exporting-to-saudi.com

Call us: +971 50 459 9607 / +971 4 268 2716
Email us: staff.saudi@cotecna.com



[cotecna_group](#)



[cotecna.inspection](#)



[Cotecna Inspection](#)